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Department of State NO. 14

PRESS AND RADIO NEWS CONFERENCE, TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 16, 1954
11:00 A.M., E.S.T.

SECRETARY DULLES: I have one prepared statement which I would like to make. I hope that by the time this conference breaks up there will be mimeographed copies available to you. It is in the process of being mimeographed at the present time. (See Press Release No. 646 on Bipartisanship which the Secretary read at this time.)

SECRETARY DULLES: If you have any questions now I will be glad to tackle them.

Q. Mr. Secretary, you have mentioned David Bruce, and said there were many other Democrats. Could you mention three or four others?

A. I would rather not try to mention them. I think it is very easy to find them. As a matter of fact, I have been subject, as you know, to very considerable criticism because there are too many.

Q. Mr. Secretary, the Senate Majority Leader in a speech yesterday calling for a review of our foreign and military policies, among other things, stated as his belief that "The Soviet Union" -- I am quoting--"is advancing the Trojan horse of co-existence only for the purpose of gaining sufficient time to accomplish what we may term atomic stalemate" and so forth. Could you give us your view or the Administration's view at this point on co-existence?

A. Well, that would require somewhat of a philosophical treatise I think. Of course, we all, I believe, accept the thesis of co-existence, if by that you mean that people who think differently are still going to exist in the world. And in that sense, there is, of course, co-existence. But, co-existence in the sense of a compatibility of our different philosophical views about the nature of man and the nature of the universe, that, I do not think is practical. I am not sure in what sense the phrase was used by Senator Knowland.

Q. Do you view it, sir--co-existence as now practiced widely and publicly by the Soviet Union--as something of a"Trojan horse" to use his phrase?

A. Well, I have no doubt that the Soviet Communist leaders are up to various tricks and devices to try and extend their power and influence in the world. I don't think that many

people

people who seriously study the subject believe that there has been a basic change in the objectives of Soviet Communist leaders. There are changes of tactics from time to time. The question as to whether those changes of tactics involve acceptable solutions for the free world, or whether they are tricks which must be shunned--that is something that has to be determined on the basis of analyzing each situation when it comes up. Surely, the United States is not unaware of the dangers, and I do not know of any of our allies who are unaware of the dangers.

Q. Would you comment on the Soviet alleged broadcast? The Soviet radio reported at 4:00 a.m. this morning to the effect that the Soviet Union intended to take further measures, if necessary, to prevent the integration of Germany and so on through the new treaties?

A. No, I was not up at four o'clock this morning. (laughter)

Q. Mr. Secretary, do you consider the new conciliatory attitude which we have heard in the last week as a trick or device of which we must beware?

A. To the extent that there is a shift in Soviet tactics, and there may be some shift, I think that that implies a failure of their prior policies, and when those who are hostile to you are required to change their policies because their earlier ones have failed, that is nothing, I think, to be despondent about. Of course, it requires one to be alert for the future.

Q. Mr. Secretary, Senator Knowland in his speech before the Senate yesterday asked for a rather broad Congressional review of foreign and defense policy with a suggestion that there was a need for a basic change in the direction of our policy. Could you comment on that speech?

A. Well, of course, the foreign policies of the United States are under constant review and study by the National Security Council; we do not go in for reviews as a sporadic thing at long intervals. They are under constant change and constant study. The meeting to be held tomorrow at the White House will bring the Congressional leaders up to date so far as our thinking on these problems is concerned.

Q. Do you think then that Senator Knowland made any great contribution in his proposal yesterday?

A. Well,

A. Well, I prefer not to answer that question because I'm a little too closely involved.

Q. Mr. Secretary, arising out of the latest Soviet note suggesting a European Conference, and the comments on it in PRAVDA and ISVESTIA, there has been some suggestion that the Soviets might be attempting to form an Eastern European Union in counterpart to the Western union, incorporating East Germany in the East European union, and that this might take place at the conference on November 29. Could you comment on that possibility and say what the attitude of the United States would be towards an Eastern European union?

A. The United States view has been that there already exists what the Soviets themselves have referred to as a monolithic system, and in fact we believe that such satellite countries as Poland, Czechoslovakia, Hungary, East Germany, are, in fact, already incorporated very solidly into the Soviet bloc system. No new action that I can think of would make their governments more servile than the governments which the Soviet Union has imposed upon them. It is, of course, always possible to devise a different form, that is a possibility, but, as far as the fact goes--the reality of their being part of the bloc which is infinitely more tied together and militaristic than the Western European countries--as far as that fact is concerned, there is no possibility of doubt about it.

Q. Mr. Secretary, has Senator Knowland in the last few weeks sought you out in any way and attempted to exchange views with you or to express these misgivings he has about the present Administration's foreign policy?

A. I have had one meeting with Senator Knowland since the Congress came back into session, in addition to telephone conversations, and, of course, he was present last week when we had the hearing on the Manila Pact.

Q. Well, can you throw any light on what seems to some of us to be a rather peculiar situation of the Majority Leader in the Senate leading an opposition against the Administration's foreign policy in the Senate?

A. I would suggest that you seek enlightenment on that in some other quarter.

Q. Sir,

Q. Sir, may I revert to your opening statement and ask whether you intend to employ a Democrat in as high a capacity as the one in which you yourself were employed by the Government while the Democrats were in power?

A. Let me say, first of all, that Mr. Bruce, to whom I referred, occupies precisely the same position which I occupied when I was in the State Department. I was a consultant to the Secretary of State. I was given a special mission, that is, to negotiate the Japanese Peace Treaty and the related security treaties. He was given a comparable mission in relation to Europe. Our position and status were exactly the same.

Q. Mr. Secretary, there have been reports that Mr. Bruce is coming home to retire. Do you plan to replace him in that event?

A. Well, these matters are all questions of individuals. You have to have persons who are competent, trustworthy, and who responsibly represent the interests that should be represented in the making of foreign policy, so it is not a question which I can answer in the abstract. Senator Vandenberg, perhaps you may recall, said that bi-partisanship is not a formula but it is an attitude. And I do not think that it is possible to put bi-partisanship within the compass of some arbitrary formula. I think as far as attitude is concerned, the attitude of this Administration is quite clear.

Q. Have you sought, sir, to get a list of possible Democrats who might serve in the Department from either the Democratic leadership on the Hill or elsewhere?

A. I have not felt that that was primarily my responsibility, although wherever I find someone who I believe can help in the making of a better foreign policy by reason of his qualifications, I am glad to take him whether he is a Republican or a Democrat. So far as my position in the past was concerned, it was suggested by the titular leader of the Republican Party and by the Republican Party ranking member of the Senate Foreign Relations Committee.

Q. Mr. Secretary, is there an alternative to peaceful co-existence, and, if so, what is it?

A. I don't think it is profitable to get into a discussion of an extremely abstract philosophical concept called "co-existence" which can mean any one of many things. Before I went into such a discussion, I would have to ask you what you mean by "co-existence" and I expect that would take more time than we can devote to it at this meeting this morning. I do not know what the phrase means except that I know it means many different things to different people. One of the troubles of dealing with the Communists is that they

they have a set of words which mean one thing to them, and a different thing to us, and unless you understand what their meaning is you get into many pitfalls by using their words. To them, for example, "peace" means something totally different from what peace means to us. "Democracy" means to them something totally different from what it means to us. And if we think that we are using words in the same sense, then we get ourselves into very great trouble.

Q. Mr. Secretary, President Eisenhower used the words "modus vivendi" many times. What is your opinion on that? If the word "co-existence" is confused, what about the expression "modus vivendi"?

A. Well, "modus vivendi" in English, I suppose, means that you find a way to live together, and, as I said before, I think it is generally assumed that there will continue for many years to be in the world both Communists and anti-Communists. Neither is going to kill off all the others. Therefore some will continue to live; therefore, there will be a method of living; that is what "modus vivendi" means as I understand it.

Q. Mr. Secretary, I think you probably referred to this in previous discussion. You were quoted second and third hand in your remarks at a luncheon in New York yesterday about the possibilities of increased hostilities in the area of Formosa. In view of those various versions of your remarks I wonder if you could shed light on what your attitude is about that?

A. I said that the Chinese Communist professions of intention to conquer Formosa constituted a serious cloud on the horizon because if those professions were to be carried into action, it would involve hostilities with the United States.

Q. Could you, sir, predict or foresee an increase in hostile action in that area?

A. No.

Q. Mr. Secretary, in your opinion would ratification of the Saar Agreements in Paris and Bonn release the United States from its standing commitment to support the separation of the Saar from Germany and its economic union with France?

A. I expect that that question of the Saar will be up for discussion with the French Prime Minister, Mendes-France, whom we are welcoming here tomorrow. And I would prefer not to discuss it in advance of talking with him.

Q. Mr. Secretary

Q. Mr. Secretary, could you tell us what you think of the latest Russian note which proposes a 25-nation conference, and specifically whether the United States has any intention of accepting this proposal?

A. I would say that the proposal bears on its face evidence that the Soviet Union does not expect it to be accepted, because it would be totally impossible, from a purely physical standpoint, for the delegations of the number of nations involved to gather in Paris or Moscow on the 29th of November, which is less than two weeks from now. Therefore, as I say, I do not think that the Soviets themselves expected acceptance, and I do not think we shall surprise them in that respect.

Q. Mr. Secretary, I don't think it was disclosed as to who selected the board that passed on John Paton Davies. Can you tell us who selected the board?

A. No, I'm sorry, I can't tell you that. That was all done while I was out of the country. It was done under the regular procedures, but I cannot tell you.

Q. Would that be Scott McLeod?

A. I know that the Acting Secretary of State took personally a concern in seeing that it was a high-class board, but I know only--

Q. Did he pass on the competency of the board?

A. I can't answer that question. The board, as you know, is chosen from a panel of the members of other agencies.

Q. Well, someone must have recommended to the Acting Secretary, would that not be true, the board?

A. I don't know whether it was recommended to him or whether he made the recommendations himself. I know he took a personal interest in the matter, but just to what extent I don't know because I was not in the country at the time.

Q. Mr. Secretary, are you prepared to say whether the Tachen Islands are considered part of Formosa?

A. They are not considered part of Formosa, although they conceivably could be involved in the defense of Formosa. They are approximately, as I recall, 200 miles north of Formosa.

Q. I'm a little

Q. I'm a little puzzled, sir, what is meant by "part of Formosa". They obviously aren't part of the Island system. Could you tell me whether you answered the question in a political sense?

A. Well, there is, as you perhaps recall, a special juridical status which applies to Formosa and the Pescadores because Formosa and the Pescadores were for approximately 60 years, since I think 1893, under the sovereignty of Japan. Japan, by the Japanese Peace Treaty and by the treaty between Japan and the Republic of China, renounced its right, title and interest in those Islands. But these Islands were never reconveyed in any formal sense to any other country. Therefore, those Islands have a distinctive international status, which is not shared by the other Islands mentioned and with Tachen. Also, Tachen Island is quite remote physically from Formosa and the Pescadores, but is related to them in the sense that there is on that Island, I believe, an early warning system which would detect air attacks against Formosa from the Shanghai complex of air bases.

Q. Could you tell us, sir, what is the status of that generally, of Tachen? You say it is different.

A. It is a Chinese Island which is occupied by the forces of the Republic of China.

Q. Does that, sir, come under the protection of the Seventh Fleet? Could you enlighten us on that, sir?

A. The orders to the Seventh Fleet, as I think are well known, are to defend Formosa. Now, what is implied in the defense of Formosa depends a good bit on what the enemy does if it plans to attack Formosa.

Q. Mr. Secretary, there have been published reports since the Denver National Security Council meeting that you concurred in a recommendation from a majority of the Joint Chiefs of Staff that United States aircraft should be used if necessary against the Chinese Mainland targets there in defense of Quemoy. Could you comment on those reports?

A. I do not think I can properly comment on positions which were taken at the meetings of the National Security Council. If we once get into making public statements about that it destroys the necessary security which surrounds those meetings. I prefer to be excused from answering that question. The matter was discussed, as you know, at the Denver meeting of the National Security Council which I attended on my return from Manila.

Q. Mr. Secretary

Q. Mr. Secretary, does your reply mean that your earlier statement about hostilities, about Communist China becoming involved in hostilities with the United States, would that apply to an attack on the Tachen Islands by the Chinese Communists?

A. Well, that all depends on a lot of the circumstances.

Q. Mr. Secretary, you have suggested that a shift in the Soviet tactics indicated a failure of prior policy. Does a shift in our tactics suggest a failure of any of our policies?

A. Not if it is designed to meet the new policies of the opposition.

Q. Mr. Secretary, do you take seriously the reports that the Soviets may impose a new blockade on West Berlin if the Paris Pact were ratified?

A. I have not seen any such threat. The position of the three Western occupying Powers in Berlin has been made abundantly clear recently. We went out of our way to re-emphasize our intention to continue the present position in Berlin. I have no reason to think that the Soviet Union will attempt to take any foreseeable measures against it. If they did, the consequences could be very serious as indicated by the reaffirmation which the three Western Powers made, I think in London, of their prior position with reference to holding on in Berlin.

Q. Mr. Secretary, can you tell us under what circumstances the United States might defend the Tachen Islands and bring the group within the protection of the Seventh Fleet?

A. No, I could not do that without divulging essentially military information.

Q. Mr. Secretary, there is new evidence that the Geneva Pact has been violated in Indochina. Is any action or any steps contemplated to secure enforcement of it?

A. The United States, as you know, is not a party to those Agreements and therefore is not legally in a position to object or protest to violations of those Agreements. We naturally view with concern any violation of those Agreements, but we are not, as I say, ourselves in a position to claim any rights under the Agreements or to protest violations of them. We did not associate ourselves with them at Geneva.

Q. Last week,

Q. Last week, sir, in that connection you said you did not then have sufficient hard information on some of these violations. Have you received since then adequate information to substantiate the press stories that the Communists are preventing large numbers of Catholic and other refugees from the North from moving to the South, which the Geneva Pact would allow them to do?

A. The information which we get on those matters inevitably comes through indirect channels and is not easy to verify. We are trying to get together all the information we can on that subject and at the hearing before the Foreign Relations Committee last week Senator Knowland asked that we should try to put together and present to the Committee in Executive Session such information as we had on that subject and we are actually engaged on that task at the present time. We have a good deal of information but the question of sorting out what is really dependable information and what is possibly hearsay is not an easy task.

Q. Mr. Secretary, have we any information indicating that the Russians have given, lent, or sold naval craft to Communist China?

A. We have no information except what can be inferred from the fact that they apparently do have some such craft as indicated by the recent torpedoing of the Chinese Nationalist ship and the fact that, as far as we know, the Chinese themselves do not have the facilities for building that type of craft.

Q. Mr. Secretary, there have been reports that the service schools have been forbidden to debate whether we should recognize Peiping or admit it to the United Nations. Did the State Department or you have any hand in such an order?

A. No, we had nothing to do with it.

Q. Mr. Secretary, can we expect a conclusion to the conversations with Nationalist China for a security pact at any time in the near future?

A. As I have said before, those talks have been going on sporadically for approximately a year. There have been periods in the past when they have been rather actively pursued and then they have died away. I would say that there is, I think today, more prospect of a positive conclusion than there has been in the past. But I would not want to predict that necessarily there will be. Even if there were not a conclusion at this time, it does not exclude the possibility that they might revive again in the future. But I would say that they have gone further now than they ever have before.

Q. Mr. Secretary

Q. Mr. Secretary, one more point on Senator Knowland's dissent. He spoke, beside co-existence, of atomic stalemate. Certainly, he said atomic stalemate would subject the West to nibbling aggression and infiltration. In the event of an atomic stalemate with Russia, do you foresee the West being utterly powerless in using Point IV, alliances and other means of defending itself against aggression?

A. Well, the free nations largely under the leadership of the United States have been continuously taking measures which were calculated to meet the so-called nibbling away process. I would say on the whole those measures have been quite successful. Certainly, if there is an intensification of those efforts by the Soviet Union, that might require a corresponding intensification of counter measures on the part of the free nations. Fortunately by now many of the free nations, particularly those in Europe, are already sufficiently strong economically and socially in their own right so that the danger is not nearly as great as it might have been some years ago. And if the unity which is designed by the London and Paris Accords is consummated, then I think the risk in that part of the world will have very considerably diminished because that unity is designed not merely to provide a military unity but a general cohesion and fellowship and association in economic and social matters as well.

Q. Mr. Secretary, I think we interrupted you a while ago on one of your answers. I'd like to restate the question in this way. Although foreign policy is constantly under review in the National Security Council, do you favor at this time a public review and discussion of foreign policy?

A. I believe that there is no time when it is inadvisable to discuss and talk about foreign policy. In other words, I believe that foreign policy should not only be under constant review within the agencies of the government, such as the Department of State and the National Security Council but I believe that the public is generally entitled to know, subject to security requirements, what our views are about the international situation and be satisfied that we have adequate measures to meet them. Therefore, I am never afraid at any time to have a discussion of these matters. I have myself, I think, gone pretty far in talking about foreign policy. I have made frequent radio and television talks. I have these press conferences quite frequently at which I answer your questions about foreign policy. I do not think that there should ever be the impression that there is any blackout of discussion about foreign policy. I do not myself see any emergency which requires either that review or discussion should be on any different basis from what it normally is.

Q. Do

Q. Do you think, sir, there is any need for a basic change in direction of our foreign policy?

A. I think our foreign policy has taken into account all necessary elements. Now, as I say, if the Communists make basic changes in policy, if their emphasis shifts from one line to another, that often calls for a corresponding shift on our part. It's like any game that you play. In football if one side shifts to an unbalanced line the other may have to make a shift to compensate for that. In that respect, foreign policy is flexible in that it takes account of the dispositions and the tactics of those who are trying to seek objectives which are incompatible with our own best interests. We don't know yet very clearly just what is behind the Soviet words. In a sense you may say that their soft words involve themselves some change of tactics. But one must look behind the words to see what the deeds are, and I don't perceive as yet any particular change in the actions, the conduct, the deeds of the Soviet Communists and their associates.

Q. Mr. Secretary, would you identify the principal issue or two which is holding up the Security Pact with Chiang?

A. Other than to say that it is complicated to make a security pact under the conditions of unrest which exist in that part of the world. That involves some novel problems. We did not make the Korean Treaty until after there was an armistice, for example. Therefore, we are confronted by new and somewhat difficult problems and it makes the conclusion of this thing a little more difficult, and more complicated than in the case of other countries that we have made security treaties with.

Q. Do you mean by that we are afraid of being drawn into a Chinese civil war?

A. Well, we do not want to be drawn into any war unless we ourselves decide that it is necessary because of the enemy action. We want to keep control of our own foreign policy.

Q. Mr. Secretary, can you comment whether there is any conference contemplated of the Manila Pact Powers to study subversion in South East Asia?

A. I didn't quite hear what you said.

Q. Is there any conference to be held for studying such problems?

A. Well,

A. Well, I said in my testimony on this subject before the Foreign Relations Committee last week that it might be useful for the representatives of countries who are parties to the Manila Pact to exchange views without necessarily waiting the coming into force of that Pact, particularly with reference to the problem of subversion which is quite acute in Indochina. That would not of course be technically a meeting under the treaty because there cannot be a meeting of the Council under the treaty until the treaty is in force. But there could be a meeting of the representatives of those same countries and at that meeting preliminary planning could be done so as to avoid the loss of time in a situation where time may not be working to our advantage as things are now.

Q. Thank you, sir.

(The Press Conference adjourned at 11:43 p.m.)

Henry Suydam